

US equities slip as yields rise and volatility spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

All major US equity indices closed lower on Thursday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.48%** to 7,619.98. The VIX surged **+7.95%** to 17.10, reflecting heightened risk appetite.

Yield pressure intensified as the 10-year Treasury fell to 4.96% (-0.28%). Energy prices jumped, with WTI crude up **+1.74%** at 103.15, while defensive sectors such as health care and consumer staples posted the day's only gains.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,619.98	-0.48%	
Dow Jones	52,421.20	-0.29%	
Nasdaq 100	29,127.16	-0.82%	
Russell 2000	2,892.24	-0.40%	
VIX	17.10	+7.95%	Risk gauge
10Y Yield	4.96%	-0.28%	
WTI Crude	103.15	+1.74%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	665.60	+2.71%
GOOGL	349.39	+3.22%
MSFT	505.41	+1.97%
AVGO	344.72	-4.77%
NVDA	210.96	-3.36%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	META
Q3 Revenue	38.2 bn
YoY Growth	+12.4%
Earnings per Share	9.84
Guidance	Revenue +10% YoY, EPS +8% YoY

Meta beat revenue expectations and lifted its FY guidance, driven by stronger ad spend in Asia-Pacific. The upbeat outlook lifted sentiment in the communication services sector, the only group posting a net gain.

Macro & Fed

- Federal Funds Rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 4.96% (down 0.28 bp)
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 10:30 am, PCE 12:00 pm, Initial Jobless Claims 3:00 pm

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated after recent airstrikes, keeping oil markets tight.
- China's Q3 GDP growth revised up to 5.2%, supporting risk-on sentiment in Asian markets.
- Eurozone manufacturing PMI slipped to 44.7, indicating continued contraction.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 am	JPM	Net interest income trend
10:00 am	TSLA	Production updates from Gigafactory Berlin
10:30 am	XOM	Impact of higher crude prices on margins
11:00 am	NVDA	GPU demand amid AI spending slowdown

Stocks worth watching

- **JPM** – rising rates could boost net interest margins.
- **XOM** – crude price rally supports earnings outlook.
- **UNH** – health-care cost inflation remains a tailwind.
- **KO** – consumer staples resilience amid market volatility.
- **AMD** – AI chip demand versus inventory buildup.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further 10-year yield rise above 5.00% could pressure equities.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict pushing oil above 110 USD.
- Disappointing CPI data reigniting inflation concerns.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Meta's guidance spurs a rally in communication services.
- Strong Q3 earnings from banks lift financials.
- Gold stabilises below 4,350, easing safe-haven demand.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — S&P 500

CNBC — VIX

SEC — Company Filings

Trading Economics — US CPI